AI Ethics in College
ISTM 209 | Reena Vollala | October 18, 2026

A. Correct Use of AI in College
AI can be a useful study resource when I am struggling to understand a concept from class. For example, I can ask for another explanation of a database relationship or request practice questions on cybersecurity. I should compare the answer with course materials instead of assuming the tool is always correct. If an instructor allows AI-assisted editing, I can use suggestions to make my writing clearer. I still need to make my own decisions about which suggestions to accept. I should acknowledge AI help when my professor requires disclosure. I should also avoid sharing private information about other students or my workplace. Using AI this way can strengthen my understanding without replacing my responsibility for the assignment.
Prompt to ChatGPT: Do you agree with this paragraph? Explain your reasoning and suggest an improvement.
AI evaluation of the paragraph
Yes, I agree with your argument that AI is best used to support studying rather than to do the assignment for you. Your examples about database practice questions and checking course materials make the paragraph concrete. One improvement would be to explain what you would do if the AI answer conflicted with your textbook or professor. You could also mention that different classes have different AI policies, so you should check the rules each time.

B. Incorrect Use of AI in College
Using AI to write an entire assignment and claiming it as my own can be academically dishonest. It is especially problematic if the professor explicitly requires original student writing. Copying AI-generated citations without checking the sources can introduce false information. Using AI to answer questions during a test when outside help is prohibited is another form of misconduct. Students should not upload another person's private data without permission. AI can also give convincing but incorrect answers that lead to mistakes. Relying on it for every task may prevent students from practicing important skills themselves. I believe students should understand the rules, verify information, and be transparent about any AI assistance.
Prompt to ChatGPT: Do you agree with this paragraph? Explain your reasoning and suggest an improvement.
AI evaluation of the paragraph
I agree that presenting AI-generated work as your own can be dishonest, especially when the instructor asks for original writing. Your examples of fabricated citations and unauthorized exam help clearly show different kinds of misuse. I would make one distinction: using AI to draft text is not always prohibited, but the student must follow the specific assignment policy and disclose help when required. Your paragraph could be even stronger with a short example of how to correct a mistaken AI citation before turning in work.